

Reading

The Friend Who Never Gave Up on Me

Before you read

- Look at the title. What kind of friend do you think the writer is describing?
- Think of a friend who has supported you during a difficult time.

Everyone has a friend who they will never forget, and for me, that friend is Ceren. We met in the seventh grade, on the first day when our new class was formed, and we have been close ever since. Ceren is the kind of person who notices when something is wrong, even before you say a word.

Two years ago, I was going through a difficult period at school, which affected my grades and my confidence. Ceren, who could see that I was struggling, started walking home with me every day just to talk. She never told me what to do; instead, she asked questions that helped me understand my own feelings better.

The place where we had our longest conversations was a small park near our school, which has a bench under an old tree. That bench is where we solved most of our problems, from small arguments with classmates to bigger worries about the future. It became a kind of second home for us.

What I admire most about Ceren is her loyalty. She is a friend whose honesty I can always trust, even when the truth is uncomfortable. Last year, when I made a decision that most people disagreed with, Ceren was the only one who asked me to explain my reasons before judging me.

Now that we are in different classes, we don't see each other every day, but the bond we built has not weakened. Whenever I need someone to talk to, Ceren is still the first person I call. She taught me that a real friend is someone who stays, not just when things are easy, but especially when they are not.

1. When did the writer and Ceren first meet?
 - a. In primary school
 - b. On the first day of seventh grade
 - c. At a birthday party
 - d. During a school trip
2. Ceren told the writer exactly what to do to solve the problem. — *True / False*
3. The bench under the old tree is the place _____ they had their longest conversations.
4. What does the writer admire most about Ceren?
 - a. Her sense of humour
 - b. Her loyalty and honesty
 - c. Her intelligence
 - d. Her generosity with money
5. Rewrite as one sentence using a relative pronoun: The writer made a decision. Most people disagreed with the decision. (*The writer made a decision...*)

6. According to the text, Ceren and the writer are now in the same class. — True / False

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After you read

- Do you agree that a real friend is someone who stays during difficult times? Why or why not?
- Describe a place that is special to you and a friend, using 'where'.

Our Ten-Year Reunion

Before you read

- What do you think happens at a class reunion?
- Have you ever met a childhood friend again after a long time?

Last month, my old classmates and I organised a reunion, which took place exactly ten years after we finished middle school. The event, which was held in a restaurant near our old school, brought together almost thirty former students, some of whom I hadn't seen since graduation.

The person who worked hardest to organise everything was Burak, a classmate whose energy for planning events never seems to disappear. He created a group chat where everyone could share memories, photos and, eventually, their availability for the big day.

When the evening finally arrived, it was strange to see faces that I remembered as children now belonging to adults with jobs, families and completely different lives. The first person I recognised was Selin, whose laugh had not changed at all in ten years. We talked for almost an hour about the summer when our whole class went camping together.

One moment that made everyone emotional was when we watched an old video, which someone had saved from our final week of school. In the video, our teacher, who had since retired, gave a short speech about friendship that none of us had fully understood at the age of fourteen.

By the end of the night, we had exchanged numbers, made plans for a smaller gathering, and remembered why some of these friendships, despite the years when we drifted apart, still mattered. As Burak said in his closing toast, a good friend is someone who, no matter how much time passes, can still make you feel like you're fifteen again.

1. How long after graduation did the reunion take place?

- a. Five years
- b. Eight years
- c. Ten years
- d. Fifteen years

2. Burak created a group chat _____ everyone could share memories and photos.

3. Selin's laugh had changed a lot in ten years. — True / False

4. What made everyone emotional during the reunion?

- a. A speech by Burak
- b. An old video from their final week of school
- c. A photo slideshow
- d. A gift from the teacher

5. Combine: Our teacher gave a speech about friendship. Our teacher had since retired. (Our teacher, who...)

6. According to Burak's toast, what makes someone a good friend?

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- ☐ a. Living nearby
- ☐ b. Being able to make you feel young again despite time passing
- ☐ c. Remembering everyone's name
- ☐ d. Organising events well

After you read

- Would you enjoy attending a reunion with old classmates ten years from now? Why or why not?
- Describe a childhood friend whose personality you remember clearly.